

Mike Personal Website — Build Spec for Replit

Goal

Build a personal website for Mike Lewis that does **three jobs at once**: 1. Clearly explain who Mike is and what he does 2. Convert strong-fit founder/CEO visitors into calls or inquiries 3. Give current clients a clean place to understand how to work with him

This should feel like a **high-end advisor / coach site**, not a corporate consultancy and not a fluffy life coach site.

The site should communicate:

- brutal clarity
- strategic depth
- warmth without softness
- operator credibility
- coaching depth
- strong point of view

It should feel like: **founder coach meets elite operator meets thoughtful strategist**.

Brand Positioning

Core idea: **We forge founder outcomes**.

Expanded positioning: Mike helps founders and CEOs change not just how fast they move, but where they're going.

He works at the intersection of:

- strategy
- execution
- leadership
- psychology
- accountability

This is not generic coaching. It is not therapy. It is not lightweight mentoring. It is a blend of:

- coach
- advisor
- operator
- thought partner

Target Audience

Primary:

- startup CEOs
- founders
- senior leaders in scaling companies
- ambitious people dealing with growth, pressure, leadership, org design, or clarity problems

Secondary:

- potential clients referred through network
- current clients
- investors or operators evaluating Mike's style

The site should quickly help a visitor answer:

- Is Mike for someone like me?
- What does he actually do?
- What is his philosophy?
- What does working with him look like?
- Do I trust this person enough to talk to him?

Desired Tone

Writing tone:

- direct
- sharp
- insightful
- confident
- human
- not overdesigned in language
- occasional cleverness is fine, but no trying too hard

Design tone:

- premium but restrained
- modern
- clear hierarchy
- lots of breathing room
- strong typography
- minimal clutter
- serious and thoughtful, not sterile

Avoid:

- startup bro clichés
 - coaching clichés
 - giant walls of text
 - excessive animations
 - vague inspirational fluff
 - stock-photo energy
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Site Map

Build the site with these top-level pages:

1. **Home**
2. **How I Think**
3. **Work With Me**
4. **Client Operating System**
5. **Proof**
6. **Contact**

Optional later: 7. **Writing / Ideas**

1. HOME PAGE

Purpose

This is the main landing page Mike can send to anyone. It should explain the offer fast, qualify the audience, and drive them toward either contacting Mike or exploring deeper pages.

Home Page Structure

Hero section

Headline ideas:

- **We forge founder outcomes.**
- Alternative subheadline: **I help founders and CEOs change not just how fast they move — but where they're going.**

Supporting copy: Mike works with startup CEOs and leaders on the problems that matter most: strategy, execution, leadership, accountability, and the inner game that drives all of it.

Primary CTA:

- **Work with Mike**

Secondary CTA:

- **How Mike Thinks**

Hero visual direction:

- keep it minimal
 - possibly just typography and subtle design system shapes
 - optional black-and-white portrait later, but not required for v1
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Section: Who this is for

Use cards or clean columns.

Headline: **Who this is for**

Copy should communicate that Mike works best with people who:

- are ambitious and want to build something meaningful
- are carrying real responsibility
- want truth, not comfort
- are open to being challenged
- need help with both external execution and internal growth

Also include a quiet disqualifier: This is not for people looking for cheerleading, passive advice, or someone to tell them they're already doing great.

Section: What Mike actually does

Headline: **What I actually do**

Use 3–4 strong cards:

- **Strategy** — clarify the real problem, identify leverage, make better decisions
- **Execution** — drive focus, accountability, priorities, and follow-through
- **Leadership** — strengthen presence, communication, ownership, and team design
- **Inner game** — uncover fear, ego, avoidance, and patterns that distort decision-making

This section should make clear that Mike moves fluidly between coach, advisor, and operator.

Section: Outcomes

Headline: **What changes**

Possible bullets/cards:

- clearer priorities
- faster execution
- more honest leadership
- better decision-making under pressure
- stronger teams
- less drift, more momentum
- deeper self-awareness without losing edge

This should focus on outcomes, not process.

Section: How Mike works

Headline: **How I work**

Short copy introducing a few principles:

- work on the goal line and the soul line
- tell the truth quickly
- challenge victim mode and rescuing patterns
- focus on leverage, not theater
- build clearer leaders, not dependency

Include link/button to **Work With Me**.

Section: Explore further

3 clean tiles linking to:

- **How I Think**
- **Work With Me**
- **Client Operating System**

Optional 4th tile:

- **Proof**
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Closing CTA

Headline: **Interested in working together?**

Short text: If you're building something meaningful and want sharper thinking, harder truth, and stronger execution, let's talk.

CTA:

- **Get in touch**
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2. HOW I THINK PAGE

Purpose

This replaces a generic "About Mike" page. It should not read like a resume. It should read like a worldview.

Structure

Intro

Headline: **How I think**

Short intro explaining that Mike's work is shaped by a blend of operating experience, founder empathy, coaching depth, and strategic rigor.

Section: Mission

Use the mission clearly. Possible headline: **My mission**

Core line: We forge founder outcomes.

Expanded explanation underneath.

Section: Core beliefs

Headline: **What I believe**

This should present 5–8 crisp beliefs. Examples:

- most founders are solving the wrong problem too often

- clarity is a competitive advantage
- execution failure is often emotional before it is operational
- leadership gets better when ego gets smaller
- accountability without safety creates fear; safety without accountability creates drift
- the external company is often a mirror of the internal one

These can be edited later, but the design should support a list of belief cards or stacked statements.

Section: Mike's approach

Headline: **How I work with leaders**

Explain the blend of:

- coaching
- advising
- operating
- teaching

Important nuance: Mike chooses the right mode for the right moment. This is a good place to explain that he is not attached to one identity.

Section: Long-view / 10-year plan

Headline: **Where I'm headed**

Use this area to express Mike's longer-term direction and ambition. This should make him feel like someone building a body of work, not just taking calls.

Optional section: Background

Keep this short. Only include enough credibility to establish trust. Avoid long biographies.

Possible format: A short paragraph plus a few credibility markers.

3. WORK WITH ME PAGE

Purpose

This is the sales / engagement clarity page. It explains what a working relationship looks like.

Structure

Intro

Headline: **Work with Mike**

Copy should explain that Mike works with a limited number of leaders and companies, usually in an ongoing advisory/coaching relationship.

Section: Who gets the most value

Headline: **Best fit**

Examples:

- founders navigating growth, tension, or inflection points
 - CEOs who need stronger execution and better leadership leverage
 - leaders who want real challenge, not lightweight support
 - people willing to look at both business systems and internal patterns
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Section: What engagement looks like

Headline: **What working together looks like**

Structure this as a clean list:

- session cadence (weekly / biweekly / custom)
 - format (Zoom, walk-and-talk, on-site if relevant)
 - between-session support if applicable
 - focus areas vary: strategy, org design, decision-making, leadership, accountability, personal patterns
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Section: What Mike expects

Headline: **What I expect from clients**

Examples:

- honesty
 - willingness to be challenged
 - preparation when needed
 - ownership of follow-through
 - openness to both tactical and personal work
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Section: What not to expect

Headline: **What this is not**

Examples:

- not passive advice
 - not therapy
 - not endless processing with no action
 - not outsourced accountability for someone unwilling to change
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CTA section

Invite readers to reach out.

4. CLIENT OPERATING SYSTEM PAGE

Purpose

This is mainly for active clients, though prospects can see it too. It explains how to get the most out of the relationship.

Structure

Intro

Headline: **Client Operating System**

Short explanation that this is how clients get the most leverage from working with Mike.

Section: How to show up

Examples:

- bring the real issue, not the polished version
 - say the thing you least want to say first
 - bring decisions, tensions, and stuck points
 - use the session to work, not perform
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Section: Ground rules

Examples:

- candor over image management
 - ownership over blame
 - experiments over endless debate
 - progress over perfection
 - hard conversations are part of the work
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Section: Sample agenda

Use a clean checklist-style module. Example:

- biggest issue right now
 - decision that needs to be made
 - where you're stuck
 - what matters most this week
 - what you're avoiding
 - commitments leaving the session
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Section: How Mike may challenge you

This is a strong differentiator. Examples:

- naming when you're in victim mode
 - calling out rescuing or avoidance
 - pushing for more ambition
 - separating signal from noise
 - forcing clarity where there is vagueness
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5. PROOF PAGE

Purpose

Social proof and evidence. This is missing today and should be built even if content is sparse at first.

Structure

Intro

Headline: **Proof**

Subtext: A few examples of what clients say and the kinds of outcomes this work can drive.

Section: Testimonials

Card layout. Allow room for:

- quote
 - client name
 - role / company
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Section: Case snapshots

Use compact case-study cards. Each card can include:

- company / founder (if public)
 - problem
 - shift made
 - measurable or narrative result
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Section: Pattern of impact

Optional section showing the recurring categories Mike helps with:

- fundraising clarity
 - org redesign
 - leadership growth
 - GTM focus
 - founder psychology
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6. CONTACT PAGE

Purpose

Simple, clean, high-signal inquiry page.

Structure

Headline: **Get in touch**

Short copy: If you think there may be a fit, send a note with a bit about who you are, what you're working on, and why you're reaching out.

Include:

- contact form
- optional email address
- fields: name, email, company, role, what are you dealing with, why now

Could optionally include a Calendly link later.

Navigation

Top nav should be simple:

- Home
- How I Think
- Work With Me
- Client Operating System
- Proof
- Contact

Sticky nav on desktop. Mobile nav should be clean and lightweight.

Footer

Simple footer with:

- Mike Lewis name
 - short tagline
 - nav links
 - optional LinkedIn link
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Design System Direction

Use a refined, editorial, high-trust style.

Visual style

- generous whitespace
- strong typography
- mostly monochrome or muted palette
- one restrained accent color

- rounded corners okay, but subtle
- cards should feel premium, not startup-template generic
- use sections with clear spacing and rhythm

Typography

Needs strong hierarchy.

- headlines: bold and clean
- body: highly readable
- avoid tiny type

Layout

- max-width centered content
- clear section spacing
- desktop-first but fully responsive
- avoid clutter

Components to build

- hero section
- CTA buttons
- card grids
- belief cards / philosophy cards
- testimonial cards
- case study blocks
- contact form
- section dividers

Interaction / Motion

Keep motion subtle.

- soft fade-ins
- slight hover states on cards and buttons
- no flashy movement
- site should feel calm and premium

Build Recommendations for Replit

Suggested stack:

- Next.js
- React

- Tailwind CSS
- shadcn/ui components where useful

Pages should be easy to edit later. Content should be stored in a way that can be updated without touching too much layout logic. Good options:

- local content objects / JSON for v1
 - optionally move to CMS later
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CMS / Editability

For v1, keep content simple and editable. Potential structure:

- one content file per page
- arrays for beliefs, testimonials, case studies, nav items, etc.

This will make iteration easier.

Content Notes

Use placeholders where content is not yet finalized. Specifically allow placeholders for:

- final mission language
- core beliefs
- 10-year plan summary
- testimonials
- case studies
- portrait/photo assets

The site architecture matters more than perfect copy in v1.

Conversion Goals

Primary conversion:

- inquiry / contact

Secondary conversions:

- visitor reads How I Think
- visitor reads Work With Me
- current client uses Client Operating System

Success means a visitor quickly understands:

- who Mike is
 - what makes him different
 - whether he's a fit
 - how to take the next step
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Important Strategic Notes

This site should not feel like a résumé. It should not feel like a generic consulting site. It should not feel like therapy branding.

It should feel like: **a sharp, trusted, high-end founder advisor with real operating depth and a real point of view.**

The biggest job of the site is to create the reaction: **"This guy sees the game clearly. I want to talk to him."**

Nice-to-Have Features Later

Not required for v1:

- writing / essays section
 - private client resources area
 - video intro section
 - calendar integration
 - downloadable PDF overview
 - dynamic case-study CMS
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What to Build First

Priority order: 1. Home 2. How I Think 3. Work With Me 4. Contact 5. Client Operating System 6. Proof

If time is limited, build the first four beautifully and stub the others.

Final instruction to Replit

Build this as a polished, premium, responsive personal site for Mike Lewis. Prioritize strong information architecture, clear conversion paths, beautiful typography, and easy editability. Make it feel thoughtful, confident, and sharp — not loud, not fluffy, not generic.